

What's data science?

North Star Academy Summit Program

October 2026





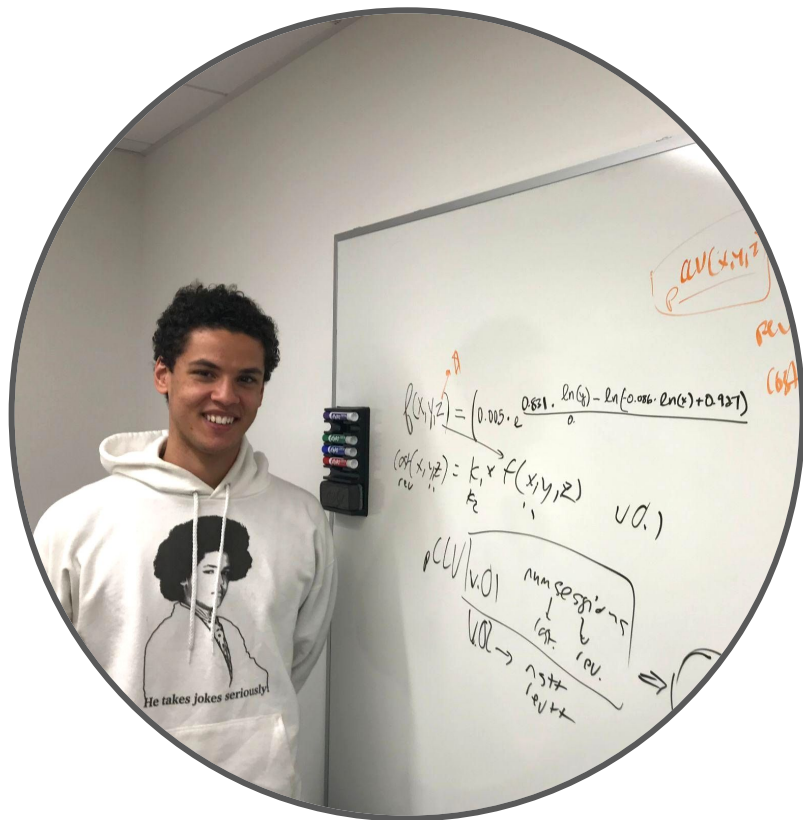
Agenda

- 1 Intro & Why Calm
- 2 What might data science look like?
- 3 My Goals for You
- 4 Your Stories and Your Goals
- 5 Questions



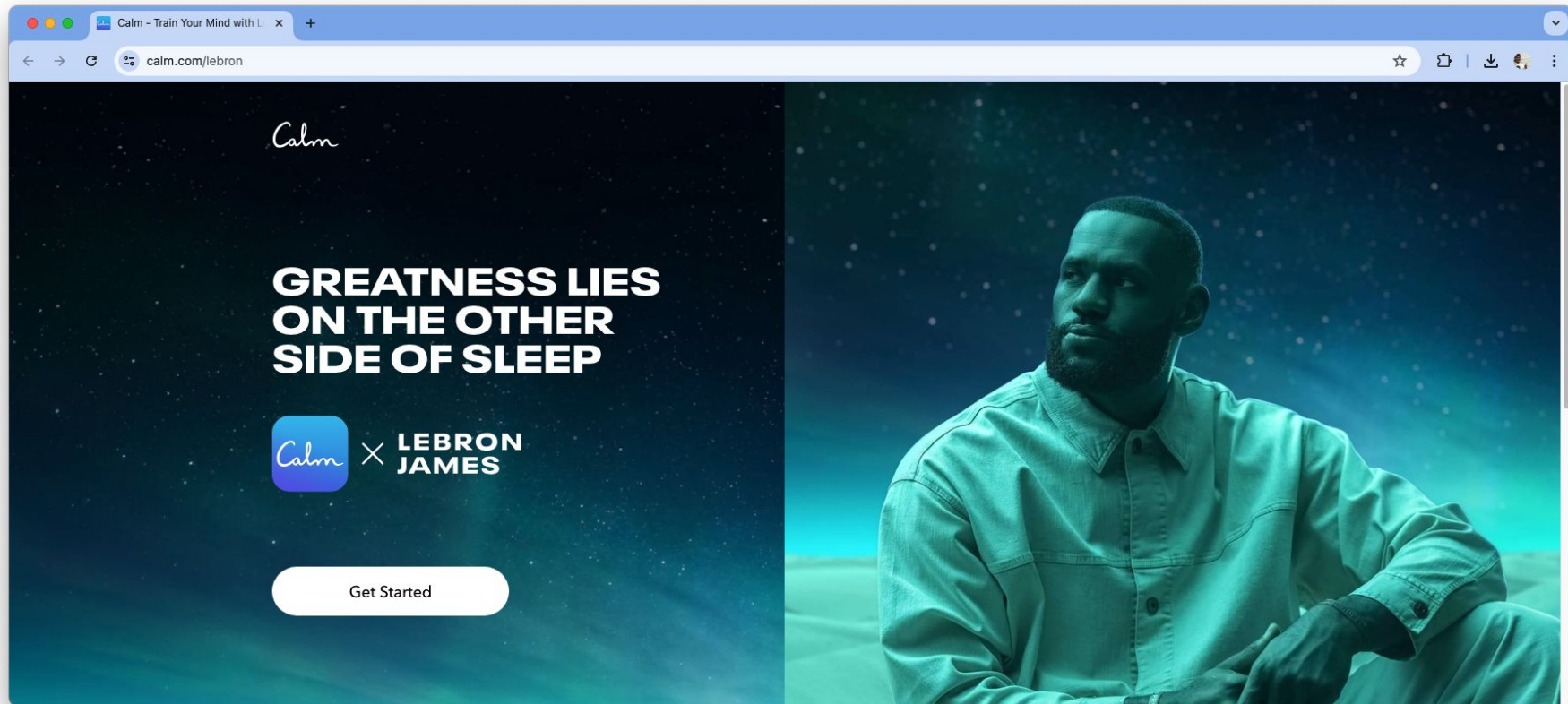
Part 1 — Intro & Why Calm

Who am I; how did I get here?



- Started analytics career in finance at Morgan Stanley, working on debt modeling. Learned data science best practices at Meta & Google and an ML startup named HeadsUp.
- Founded Hayward Data Science; have been consulting & app-developing for last 2 years.
- Favorite food is fried chicken; favorite hip-hop producer is J Dilla; favorite animal is a giraffe (plural). Love stand-up comedy. Also a pro bono lawyer.

Why Calm?



Quote from LeBron

“We all face pressure, and we all have big moments. And especially with social media, people are always watching. We’re living in a time when everyone's got fans and doubters. The one thing that's true about all human beings is that we’ve all got goals and dreams and we all got doubts and fears. Everyone's got insecurities that they might take a big shot and miss.

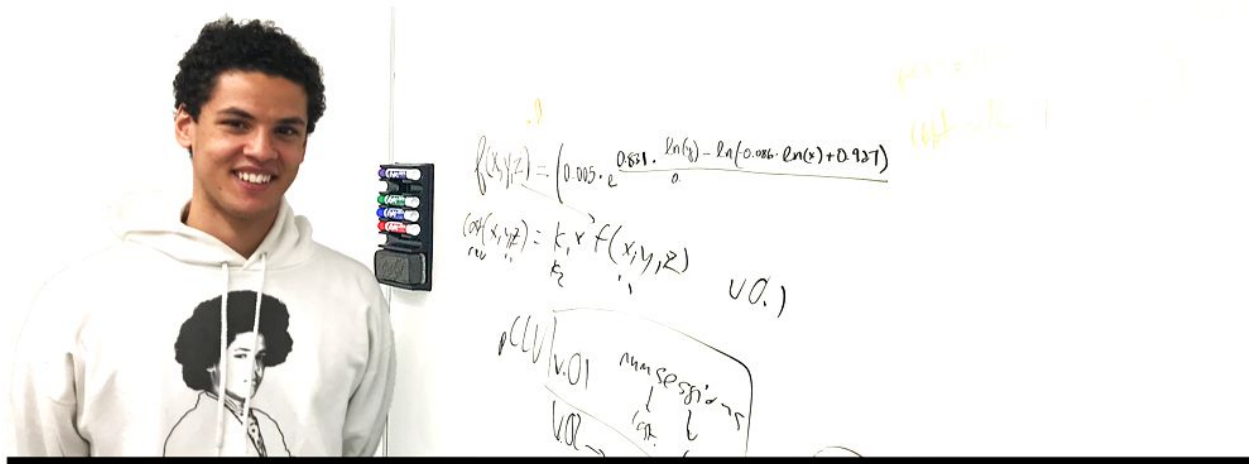
My thing is basketball, and right now I'm trying to help a team reclaim its legacy as a championship franchise. You’re dealing with your own thing right now. Maybe it’s an exam to get into college. Maybe you’re starting a new company. Maybe you want to upload that first song to SoundCloud. Maybe you’re inspired to be a stand-up comedian, and there’s an open mic night in your city. You're just not sure you got what it takes to show up in front of a bunch of strangers and grab that mic.

Well if nobody's told you yet, I'll tell you: you've got it. We just need to breathe and be in a moment.

Whatever it is, we’re all gonna face it. Whatever it is, we all need to stay calm and focus when we get there. That's what it's about. At the end of the day, those big moments: you can either own them or they own you. **Just take a deep breath, and take that shot, with a ton of focus and confidence. And you need to trust yourself. Trust that you can do it. Believe that you're the person who makes that shot.** It might sound a little corny, I know, but I’ve learned it’s true. The reason I am where I am: because people along the way helped me believe in a bigger vision of who I could be or what I could do.”



Part 2 — What might data science look like?



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Part 3 — My Goals for You

Goals

- Have fun
- Get a peek at the world of data science
- Have me as a resource for the future
- Have a foundation to learn more, if you choose to



Part 4 — Your Stories and Your Goals



Part 5 — Questions